

LET ME TRY · FREE PRINTABLE

5 Things Your 2-Year-Old Can Do Alone

A one-week independence plan · Ages 2–3

Two-year-olds want to do real work, by themselves. Your job is to make it possible: the right-sized tools, a little time, and a lot of patience with mess. Pick one activity a day and repeat it all week.

Set up once

- ○ A small stool or low table they can reach without help
- ○ Child-sized tools: a small steel jug, tumbler, katori and cloth
- ○ A low shelf with only 6–8 toys, each in its own basket
- ○ A hook at their height for a small cloth

The five activities

- ○ Chappals: velcro or slip-on. Let them sit on the floor. Line the pair up toes-to-the-door.
- ○ Pouring: start with dry rajma or chana, then a little water. Fill the jug only a third.
- ○ Washing vegetables: a wide bowl of water and 3–4 tomatoes. Show once, slowly, without talking.
- ○ Putting toys back: one basket per toy. Sing a short tidy-up song, then do it together.
- ○ Wiping spills: when water spills, calmly hand them the cloth. No rescue, no scolding.

How to show (the Montessori way)

- ○ Move slowly and use few words, so they can watch your hands
- ○ Show it once, then step back
- ○ Correct the activity, not the child: 'Let's try with less water'
- ○ Stop while they are still interested

Expect this

It will be slower and messier at first. That is the learning. Most children need many repetitions before a skill clicks, and the pride on their face when it does is worth every spill.

SOURCES AND FURTHER READING

Maria Montessori, The Absorbent Mind (on practical life and independence)
Lillard, A. S. (2017). Montessori: The Science Behind the Genius. Oxford University Press.

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